

Marwadi (Marwari), Step by Step, Sign by Sign

A gentle writing-first curriculum, one usable greeting at a time

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Starter edition — seven lessons, each no longer than five minutes.

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How to use this starter edition

Begin with no assumed Marwadi and no assumed Devanagari. Each section lasts at most five minutes. The first section gives the hand one sign to copy; later sections move through guided copy, delayed copy, and independent recall. The writing ramp never waits for an alphabet chapter and never asks for a sign that has not already been isolated.

The name in the title is deliberately double. Official and linguistic sources often use *Marwari*; many speakers and learners use *Marwadi*. This book uses Marwadi as its short name and keeps Marwari visible for discoverability.

Chapter 1 makes one narrow promise: you will be able to read, say, and write the respectful greeting राम-राम सा, and answer it. That is a real pre-A1 step, not a claim that the level is complete.

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Chapter 1

Ram-Ram Sa: A Greeting the Hand Can Make

Modes:  voice (2)  pen (5)  Hands-free start: none of the 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can recognise, read, say, copy, and write the respectful Marwadi greeting राम-राम सा, and answer it with the same greeting.

A two-line authentic greeting exchange followed by independent written recall, using only signs and language taught in the chapter.

1.1 र — one sign, and the beginning of a greeting

You do not need an alphabet first. Today your eye and hand need one sign.

Script — notice the sign

र — *ra*

Devanagari consonants carry a short *a* by default, so this is **ra**, not a bare *r*. The *r* is a quick tongue-tip tap.

Writing — guided copy

Put a finger over र and follow the printed shape. Then copy it three times, large and slow. Say *ra* each time your pen stops.

This lesson asks you to copy the shape you can see. It does not invent one universal stroke order where school traditions differ.

Before you move on

Cover the model. Point to the one you copied most clearly and say its sound.

1.2 ा — make *ra* into *rā*

Read र. (*ra*.) Copy it once.

Script — add one mark

The mark ा sits on the right of a consonant and lengthens its vowel:

र *ra* + ा *ā* = रा *rā*

Hold *ā* steady; do not turn it into English *ray*.

Writing — guided copy

- copy र
- add ा on its right
- read the result: रा *rā*

Do that three times. On the last copy, wait five seconds after looking at the model before you write.

Before you move on

Which is *ra*: र or रा? Which is *rā*?

1.3 म — your first whole written word

Write रा after looking away from the model. Check it, then begin.

Script — add म

म — *ma*

Join it to the piece you know:

रा $rā$ + म ma = राम $rām$

At the end of this word, the built-in vowel of म is not pronounced in ordinary speech. Read the whole word $rām$.

Writing — from copy to memory

1. copy म twice
2. copy राम once while looking
3. hide the model for ten seconds
4. write राम from memory, then compare

If the memory copy stalls, return only to the missing sign.

Before you move on

Read राम without using the romanization. Then write it once more.

1.4 स — a second consonant

Read राम, then write it from memory.

Script — notice and copy

स — sa

Like र, this consonant carries a short a . Do not confuse the two:

र ra · स sa

Finger-trace स, then copy it three times. Say sa as each copy finishes.

Before you move on

Cover the large model and write स once from the copy you remember.

1.5 सा — reuse a mark instead of learning a new rule

What did ा do to र? Apply the same change to स.

Script — assemble

स sa + ा $\bar{a}$ = सा $s\bar{a}$

The writing rule is old; only the combination is new. In the greeting you are building, सा is a respectful form of address.

Writing — delayed copy

Copy सा once. Look away for ten seconds, say $s\bar{a}$, and write it again. Then copy the two pieces with a space:

राम सा

Before you move on

Read राम सा. Circle the two copies of ा.

1.6 राम-राम सा — your first complete Marwadi greeting

Read राम and सा separately. You already own every sign in to-day's line.

The exchange — meet the greeting

राम-राम सा। — *Rām-rām s̄a*. — a respectful greeting

Repeat राम, then add respectful सा. Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi's *Jāgti Jot* prints this exchange:

A: राम-राम सा।

>

B: राम-राम सा, राम-राम।

That attestation is why this track begins here rather than substituting a Hindi greeting merely because the scripts are shared.

Your turn — use and write it

- *Hear:* *rām-rām sā* [YOU ANSWER: राम-राम सा]
- *Read it:* राम-राम सा [YOU SAY: the line without romanization]
- *Copy:* राम-राम सा once, keeping the hyphen and space

Before you move on

Hide the line. Say the greeting once; then write as much as you can remember.

Source: Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi, *Jāgtī Jot*, August–September 2018.

1.7 Practice — hear it, answer it, write it

With the page covered, write राम and सा separately. Check only after both are down.

The exchange

A: राम-राम सा।

>

B: राम-राम सा, राम-राम।

Run both voices once. Then cover B and answer A aloud. Switch roles.

Your turn — four-skill checkpoint

1. **Listen:** ask someone or a screen reader to say *rām-rām sā* without showing the text; identify it as a greeting. 2. **Speak:** give the greeting without reading. 3. **Read:** read राम-राम सा without romanization. 4. **Write:** close the book for fifteen seconds, then write राम-राम सा from memory. Check the repeated word, hyphen, space, and final सा.

Writing counts only if the model was hidden. Copying was the ramp; this is recall.

Before you move on

If one sign stalled, mark that sign and repeat only its short lesson tomorrow.

Pronunciation & Writing Reference

This is a lookup page, never a prerequisite gate.

The sounds in Chapter 1

- **r** in *rām* is a brief tongue-tip tap, not the English bunched or retroflex *r*. Say a quick Spanish-style single *r* if that is familiar.
- **ā** is a steady open vowel held longer than short *a*. The macron in transliteration marks length; Devanagari writes it with ा after a consonant.
- **m** and **s** are close to English *m* and *s*.

The writing rule you need first

Devanagari consonants carry a built-in short *a*. Thus र is *ra* and स is *sa*. The right-side mark ा changes that vowel to long *ā*: रा *rā*, सा *sā*. The chapter teaches only those signs and combines them as राम-राम सा.

The lessons ask learners to copy visible forms before they claim a stroke order. Handwriting conventions vary across schools, so a directional stroke sequence will be added only with a specific source. For Marwari-specific Devanagari history and characters, see the Unicode proposal on Devanagari letters for Marwari.

Glossary

This glossary collects every word and phrase taught in the book. Pronunciation appears when it differs from the written form; chapter numbers show where each entry is introduced.

राम-राम सा *rām-rām sā*

a respectful Marwadi greeting

Introduced in Chapter 1.

Review Questions

Try these without looking ahead. Every prompt comes from the same canonical lesson data as its chapter. Answers begin in the next section.

Chapter 1

1.1 र — *one sign, and the beginning of a greeting*

What sound does र carry?

1.2 ा — *make ra into rā*

What does ा do to the built-in vowel of a consonant?

1.3 राम — *your first whole written word*

Build the written word rām from its three visible pieces.

1.4 स — *a second consonant*

Which sign is sa: र or स?

1.5 सा — *reuse a mark instead of learning a new rule*

Write sā by adding the long-vowel mark to स.

1.6 राम-राम सा — *your first complete Marwadi greeting*

Give the respectful Marwadi greeting taught in this lesson.

1.7 Practice — *hear it, answer it, write it*

You hear rām-rām sā. Write the respectful reply from memory.

Answer Key

The first response is the canonical display answer. When a question accepts other authored forms, they appear underneath.

Chapter 1

1.1 र — *one sign, and the beginning of a greeting*

Answer: रा

Also accepted: र a; र

1.2 ा — *make ra into rā*

Answer: It changes short a to long ā.

Also accepted: makes it aa; lengthens a; long a

1.3 राम — *your first whole written word*

Answer: राम

Also accepted: र + ा + म; रा + म

1.4 स — *a second consonant*

Answer: स

Also accepted: the second sign; sa is स

1.5 सा — *reuse a mark instead of learning a new rule*

Answer: सा

Also accepted: स + ा; saa

1.6 राम-राम सा — *your first complete Marwadi greeting*

Answer: राम-राम सा

Also accepted: राम राम सा; rām-rām sā; ram-ram sa

1.7 Practice — *hear it, answer it, write it*

Answer: राम-राम सा

Also accepted: राम राम सा; rām-rām sā; ram-ram sa

Sources for this starter edition

The opening exchange is attested in Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi's *Jāgtī Jot*, August–September 2018. Rajasthan Foundation's official language page places Marwari among the major forms of Rajasthani. The lesson files carry the direct links. Chapter 1 is generated from those canonical files.

Index

Look up an English meaning, a dedicated language topic, or a chapter topic. Each linked reference opens the chapter where the material is introduced; the focus labels name only explicitly typed lesson sections.

A

a respectful Marwadi greeting राम-राम सा (rām-rām sā)
Chapter 1, p. 1

M

ा — **make *ra* into *rā***
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1

R

Ram-Ram Sa: A Greeting the Hand Can Make
chapter topic; Chapter 1, p. 1

Other

र — **one sign, and the beginning of a greeting**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1

राम — **your first whole written word**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1

स — **a second consonant**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 1, p. 1

सा — **reuse a mark instead of learning a new rule**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1